

Brief Correspondence

Communication is essential for being able to act and make decisions in the business world. Although some communication can take place face-to-face, a great deal of communication is conducted through text messages, e-mails, memos and letters. All four of these may be used for brief correspondence. However, each one has its own distinguishing characteristics. For instance, text messaging and e-mail are the fastest and most efficient means of written communication. Unlike electronic correspondence, memos and letters take more time.

All brief correspondence seeks the goodwill of readers. Goodwill is the value of doing things that create mutual admiration and respect. It is the feeling of friendship. In addition, writers of brief correspondence practice the principles of effective communication.

⊗. Text. Message: The term text means a stretch of language recorded for the purpose of analysis and description. It is the collection of written or spoken material that conveys a complete message. The text message may vary from a single word such as stop!, PARKING, EXIT etc. to hundreds of pages such as books. Every text has text formation devices and language units such as communicative functions, coherence, grammatical structure etc. Fonts, font size, alignment, indent, bullet and numbers, line spacing, margin, header, footer etc. are the technical aspects of identifying a text.

On the other hand, message is something that is conveyed in speech or writing from one person to another or one medium to another. The message may not be always started in verbal form but also can be conveyed by other means of non-verbal forms such as wink, gesture, posture etc. The electronic messages are generally transmitted either in teletext or videotext.



The term 'text message' is made of two separate words 'text' and 'message'. It refers to any written or typed messages that ever exist in human civilization. It may be found either in softcopy, hard copy or in archived form. Text messages are the part of technical and business communication.

### ⊗. Electronic Mails (E-Mails):

The process of sending messages from electronic media via networking system through computer to the users is called e-mail. It is the exchange of computer stored messages by telecommunication. The email messages are usually encoded in ASCII text.

The purpose of electronic mail is speedy communication, so our objectives should be to keep our message clear and brief. In the subject line, write something clear and simple which explains what our e-mail is about. Avoid using inappropriate e-mail address; register a professional sounding address.

#### Guidelines for better e-mail formatting:

- ↳ Use simple formatting, keep everything aligned with left margin.
- ↳ Keep your message formal. Do not forget to use spell check and proper grammar.
- ↳ The content should be as short as possible and less than 80 characters wide.
- ↳ Do not type your message all in uppercase; it is difficult to read.
- ↳ Include enough information.

#### Composing an e-mail Message:

To compose an e-mail message, click on 'compose new message' button on the toolbar. We will see an empty box with following parts:

- To: Enter the email address to where you are sending message.
- CC: Enter the e-mail address to where the copy of message is sent.
- Subject: Type a brief description as to what the message is about.
- Body: Type the actual message here.



9.  
⊗ Memo: A memo is a formal message to people within an organization to meet a specific need. Memoranda is the plural form as to its abbreviated form is memo. Memos are the most important form of written communication within the organizations. It is a short official note that is written to a person or to group of people. Most memos have the following key components;

- Memo ID lines
- Body of the Memo.

Writing memo usually follows a preset design that begins with memo ID lines. The ID lines include sender, receiver, date, section, subject and other necessary information. The message body of the memo can be divided into: introduction, Discussion, and Conclusion. The introductory paragraph includes the purpose of writing memo. In discussion, further details have been discussed and finally in concluding paragraph, we need to conclude memo with complimentary or directive close.

For example; For more information, contact in my personal contact number.

Example:

Nagarjuna Communication Pvt. Ltd.  
Sitapaila, Kathmandu

Date: 2078-8-10

FROM: Roshan. Bist

To : Radhika Kunwar

RE : Company Policy during Corona Virus Pandemic

Here are our plans and policies applicable to everyone in our company:

1. Employees should present in office from 10:am to 4:pm
2. All employees of this company have NRs. 1 lakh for Corona Virus Pandemic Insurance.
3. All employees are bound with rules and regulations.

All the above plans and policies are prepared with employers views and the rules made by the government during lockdown. Please, read carefully and follow these rules as soon as possible. For more information, contact our office manager Mr. Ramit Bhatt.



## \* Types of Memo:

For full memo example refer once to kec book page no 97.

1) Inquiry Memo: This memo is written to inquire for specific information. For example: Request for cost information.

2) Response Memo: This memo is written to answer the inquiry memo. For example: Response for cost information.

3) Policy/Directive Memo: A policy or directive memo states a policy or procedure we want the reader or co-worker to follow. For example: Corona Virus Pandemic Policy.

## Other types of Memo:

1) Status Memo: The status memo is written to inform about the state of a project or situation. The structure of status memo is: Purpose statement, Summary, Methods, Results and Discussion, Conclusions, Recommendations.

2) Negative Memo: The negative memos are written to reject, disagree, complain and so on. The structure of negative memo is: Problem statement, Discussion, Problem leading to the decision, Action.

3) Trip Report Memo: A trip report memo is usually written by an employee to the supervisor after the employee returns from a business venture. The structure of trip report is: Purpose statement, Summary, Discussion, Action.

4) Field/Lab Report Memo: The field or lab report memos are written to report on inspection and procedures. The structure is: Purpose of memo, Summary, Problem leading to the decision to perform the procedure, Methods, Results, Conclusions, Recommendation.

5) Personal Memo: The personal memos are written to convey private information. The structure of personal memo is not always same. It differs from person to person and also nature of message.



⑥ Letter: Letter writing is the most widely used written form of communication and sent through post, fax, e-mail, or any other media. Letter writing is used in different sectors such as administration, business, profession etc. The basic purpose of letter writing is to communicate. There are many other purposes may be to inform, to thank, to request, to reply etc.

### Parts of letter:

- 1) The heading: The heading includes sender's address and the date of the letter written. Traditionally, it is written at the right top corner of the page; however, it can also be written at the left corner of the page.
- 2) The inside address: The inside address refers to the address of the receiver. It is also known as superscription. It is written below the heading or sender's address on the left hand side of page. The inside address is mainly found either in official or in business letters.
- 3) Subject line: The subject line contains the main message of the letter which is optional in personal letters.

4) Salutation: The salutation is written just a line below subject line. The relation between sender and receiver determines what to write in salutation.

Sir/Madam → For high rank or strangers

Dear Sir/Madam → For business colleagues.

Dear Mr → For intimate person.

My Dear Mr → For more familiar person.

5) The Body: This part determines size and quality of letter which contains main message that sender wants to communicate.

6) The Subscription: It is a complimentary close like; Yours truly, Yours sincerely, Yours faithfully, Yours obediently etc.

7) Signature: It refers to full name and signature of sender written just below the subscription.

8) Enclosure: This section includes the necessary documents like certificates or other important documents mentioned under (Encl.) section.

Encl.

1. Bill of water supply.

2. Citizenship certificate.



## Example (OR Format of letter):

This is in indented style.  
In blocked style, everything like date and other starts from left side.

Date: 18 Dec, 2021

Dear Mr. Shyam

Balance of your television rental

Your television rental account is in fact paid until 23<sup>rd</sup> February, 2020. We exchanged the television for a colour set on 15<sup>th</sup> December 2020, but your invoice was unfortunately sent out before this. We have received three payments from you:

15<sup>th</sup> December, 2019      NRS 50,000

15<sup>th</sup> December, 2020      NRS 70,000

13<sup>th</sup> January, 2021      NRS 50,000

Because the rentals for the first set were more than covered by these payments, we transferred the balance (NRS 8602.00) to the other rental account. This still leaves a credit balance of NRS 7940.00. Would you like us to refund this, or will you leave it in credit for future rentals?

To help you follow this rather complicated situation, we are sending copies of two accounts, that is No. 55 78 91 99 and No. 38 00 31 00. We are sorry for the confusion.

Yours Sincerely  
Roshan. Bisb  
Manager, XYZ Dept.

⊙ Business letters: Business letter is written for exchanging information between the individuals and organizations. Writing business letters have two goals: to keep contact and relation with public & to maintain a good relationship between the offices. Business letter helps to maintain good impression and positive attitude among customers, employees, general people etc. Following are the various types of business letters:

- 1) Enquiry letter: to enquiry about quality, price, cost, discount etc.
- 2) Quotation letter: to give reply of enquiry.
- 3) Order letter: for detailed description of goods and services purchased.
- 4) Confirmation letter: Written by exporter/seller for confirmation of order.
- 5) Complaint letter: for complaint of goods due to some reason like low quality.

For more and example of these letters refer Lec



⊗. Audience: Audience are the readers of text messages, e-mails, memos, and letters. All readers have similar characteristics except the communication to be brief. Some have particular audience whereas some are sent to multiple. Always learn about audience, as much as you can. Keep your language moderately simple and natural. We should work hard to build goodwill.

Audience for text messages: Audience for text messages should be internal or external. Writer may know a little bit, or almost nothing about the reader. Sender must anticipate expectations of the audience. Anticipating reader helps to decide the levels of formality of message sent to different audiences.

Audience for e-mails: It is the most convenient and preferable medium of communication. Readers may be inside or outside the writer's organization. Readers expect messages to be relevant and clear.

Audience for memos: It is the most convenient way to communicate internally in an organization. The audience may consist of people with various roles. Writer must gather adequate information about reader before sending memo.

Audience for letters: Always remember letter represents you so make it as professional as you can. It should be clear, concise and complete.

⊗. Prewriting: Effective text messages, e-mails, memos and letters depend on planning. After analyzing audience, we need to make decisions based on what we have learned. Ask these questions before you write:

- What do I want the receiver to do?
- What is the main point?
- Does my reader need background information?
- Do I need to make message simpler for the audience?
- What questions should my correspondence answer?

In addition to answering to above questions we should take notes on details we need for the correspondence.

We should also gather facts such as: background, events that occurred, problems created, descriptions, correct name, title, spelling and address. Double check to make sure the information gathered is accurate and complete.

### ⊗. Composing the message:

The message, or the body, is the heart of the document. The message section of correspondence should be organized for the reader, not for the writer. Writers who fail to meet their readers expectations are not likely to be successful in achieving goals. Organize ideas to suit the message. Some messages are best presented in a straightforward manner. Some messages if presented bluntly and directly, are likely to offend readers.